ONE DESIRE SICKLE CELL FOUNDATION

ORGANISATIONAL, IMPACT & PARTNERSHIP PROFILE

2024 - 2026

Raising Awareness, Inspiring Hope & Advocating for Change.

A detailed profile of a youth-led Ghanaian non-profit transforming sickle cell awareness into practical action through education, screening, blood donor mobilisation, community support, partnerships and advocacy.

15,000+	6	8	400+	50+
ESTIMATED DIRECT REACH	SENIOR HIGH SCHOOLS	BLOOD DONATION DRIVES	PINTS MOBILISED	VOLUNTEERS

ONE DESIRE SICKLE CELL FOUNDATION LBG
Reg. No. CG025050426 | TIN: C006715896X

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Turning sickle cell awareness into practical action

One Desire Sickle Cell Foundation (ODSCF) is a youth-led Ghanaian non-profit organisation established in September 2024 to improve how individuals and communities understand, prevent and respond to sickle cell disease. The Foundation was created around a simple belief: awareness is most valuable when it leads to an informed and practical next step.

In its early years, One Desire has combined public education with genotype and sickling screening, voluntary blood donor mobilisation, school and community outreach, patient-centred support, youth engagement, partnership building and advocacy. Rather than treating these as disconnected events, the Foundation is developing an integrated programme model that helps people move from hearing about sickle cell disease to understanding it, knowing their status, taking appropriate action and contributing to stronger community and health responses.

Reported activity records through 2026 indicate an estimated direct reach of more than 15,000 people, engagement with six senior high schools and three rural communities, eight blood donation drives within an eleven-month period, more than 400 pints of blood mobilised, and a volunteer community of more than 50 people. Individual activations have also demonstrated the potential of youth-friendly health engagement: One Wash, One Hope recorded more than 400 attendees, 49 blood donors and 86 genotype tests, while the Osu community outreach recorded more than 70 people tested alongside medication and material support.

The Foundation is now entering a critical stage of organisational development. The next priority is to transform successful activations into repeatable programmes supported by stronger governance, monitoring and evaluation, safeguarding, volunteer systems, technical partnerships, sustainable financing and outcome measurement.

This profile presents One Desire's identity, programme model, early evidence of delivery, partnership proposition and direction for sustainable growth.

01 | WHO WE ARE

A youth-led movement turning knowledge into action

One Desire Sickle Cell Foundation (ODSCF) is a youth-led non-profit organisation working to transform how individuals and communities understand, prevent and respond to sickle cell disease. Founded in September 2024, One Desire combines awareness and education with practical opportunities to act - including genotype and sickling screening, voluntary blood donor mobilisation, community outreach, patient-centred support, partnership building and advocacy.

We believe awareness is most powerful when people are given a clear next step. Our programmes therefore go beyond telling people about sickle cell disease. We create opportunities for young people and communities to know their status, understand their choices, donate blood, access support, ask difficult questions without stigma and participate in building a more informed and supportive society.

Our work is intentionally accessible and community-facing. We engage people in schools, neighbourhoods, youth events, blood drives, community activations and public conversations - spaces where health information can become relevant to everyday life.

OUR ORGANISATIONAL IDENTITY

Legal name	One Desire Sickle Cell Foundation LBG
Registration number	CG025050426
TIN	C006715896X
Founded	September 2024
Character	Youth-led, community-centred and action-oriented
Primary focus	Sickle cell education, screening, blood donation, community support, partnerships and advocacy

02 | OUR STORY

Built from urgency. Growing through action.

One Desire was established with a conviction that sickle cell awareness should not end with a poster, a speech or a commemorative day. People need information they can understand, services they can access, communities that support them and opportunities to take meaningful action.

That conviction shaped an organisation designed to connect health education with practical response. From senior high school engagements to genotype screening, blood donation drives, community outreach and public conversations, One Desire has steadily built a model centred on participation rather than passive awareness.

The organisation's early growth has been powered by volunteers, health professionals, community partners, young people and organisations willing to contribute expertise, platforms, logistics and resources. Each activity has also helped One Desire learn what communities respond to: accessible language, respectful conversations, visible services, youth-friendly formats and partnerships that bring different forms of support together.

The next chapter is about converting this momentum into durable institutional capacity. One Desire intends to strengthen the systems behind the programmes so that community engagement can be repeated, measured, improved and expanded.

> ***"We are not building an awareness calendar. We are building a culture in which people know, act and support one another."***

03 | ORGANISATIONAL IDENTITY

Vision, Mission & Values

OUR VISION

A society where sickle cell disease is well understood, preventable through informed choices, and effectively managed with dignity and support.

OUR MISSION

To advance sickle cell awareness, education and advocacy while expanding access to genotype screening, mobilising blood donation, supporting affected individuals and communities, and promoting informed decision-making and stronger health responses.

OUR CORE VALUES

INTEGRITY

We act responsibly, communicate truthfully and seek to earn the trust of the communities and partners we serve.

RESPECT

We listen to people, honour lived experience and communicate without judgement or stigma.

EXCELLENCE & INNOVATION

We continuously improve how we educate, mobilise, communicate, measure and partner for impact.

COMPASSION

We approach sickle cell disease as a human reality and centre empathy, dignity and care in our work.

EQUITY & INCLUSION

We seek to make knowledge, opportunities and support accessible across different communities and backgrounds.

04 | WHAT WE DO

Five programme pillars. One connected purpose.

One Desire's activities are organised around five connected programme pillars. The purpose of this structure is to move from isolated activities toward a coherent programme model in which education, services, participation and advocacy reinforce one another.

EDUCATE

We deliver clear, youth-friendly sickle cell education in schools, communities, events and digital spaces. Topics include genotype, inheritance, informed choices, stigma, blood donation, care and the lived realities of sickle cell disease.

KNOW

We expand practical opportunities for genotype and sickling screening and promote appropriate counselling, referral and informed decision-making. Screening is treated as a pathway to understanding and action, not simply as a number recorded at an event.

GIVE

We mobilise voluntary blood donors and help build a culture in which blood donation is understood as a practical act of solidarity and lifesaving public-health participation.

SUPPORT

We create community-centred outreach, practical support, referral pathways and partnerships that respond to the wider realities affecting people and families impacted by sickle cell disease.

ADVOCATE

We use community experience, public engagement, partnerships and evidence to strengthen the visibility of sickle cell disease and contribute to stronger institutional and policy responses.

05 | HOW WE WORK

Youth-led. Community-centred. Partnership-driven. Action-oriented.

YOUTH-LED

We design health communication and activities that speak to young people in language, formats and environments they can engage with.

COMMUNITY-CENTRED

We take education, screening, support and mobilisation closer to people rather than expecting every interaction to begin in a formal health facility.

PARTNERSHIP-DRIVEN

Sickle cell disease crosses health, education, community, social and policy systems. We build collaborations that bring together complementary expertise and resources.

ACTION-ORIENTED

Every awareness activity should create a pathway toward an action: test, donate, ask, learn, refer, support, volunteer or advocate.

DIGNITY-FOCUSED

We communicate in ways that avoid fear, blame and stigma. Informed choice, respect and the dignity of people living with sickle cell disease remain central.

WHAT MAKES THE MODEL DISTINCTIVE

One Desire seeks to make public-health participation feel relevant to everyday life. School engagements, community outreach, blood donation, screening and youth-centred campaigns are designed to meet people in spaces where they already learn, socialise and participate. This approach allows health information to be paired with immediate opportunities for action.

06 | OUR JOURNEY

From one desire to a growing movement

23 Sep 2024	Soft launch of One Desire Sickle Cell Foundation.
18 Jun 2025	Sickle cell education engagement at Labone Senior High School.
16 & 21 Jul	Engagements at St. John's Grammar School.
23 Jul 2025	Accra Academy school outreach.
20 Sep 2025	One Wash, One Hope - youth-centred car wash, pop-up market, blood donation and genotype screening activation.
20 Dec 2025	Osu community outreach with White Jades - screening and practical community support.
24 Jan 2026	Hugs & Smiles at Dawa Tokro with The Perrie Foundation.
11 Feb 2026	Outreach and blood donation exercise at Asesewa Senior High School, with 92 students giving blood.
16 Jun 2026	Blood donation exercise at St. John's Grammar School.
19 Jun 2026	Participation in the 3rd Annual ISCC Sickle Cell Disease Conference, including moderation and closing engagement.
19 Sep 2026	You For Know - youth campaign built around knowing yourself, knowing your choices and knowing what to do.

This timeline reflects selected milestones rather than every activity. As One Desire strengthens its institutional records, a complete programme register should be maintained with dates, locations, participant numbers, services delivered, partners, costs and outcomes.

07 | IMPACT AT A GLANCE

Early evidence of reach, participation and mobilisation

15,000+ ESTIMATED DIRECT REACH	**6** SENIOR HIGH SCHOOLS	**3** RURAL COMMUNITIES	**8** BLOOD DONATION DRIVES	**400+** PINTS MOBILISED

86 GENOTYPE TESTS - ONE WASH	**70+** PEOPLE TESTED - OSU	**400+** ONE WASH ATTENDANCE
49 ONE WASH BLOOD DONORS	**92** ASESEWA STUDENT DONORS	**50+** VOLUNTEER BASE

READING THE NUMBERS RESPONSIBLY

These figures primarily demonstrate reach and participation. One Desire's next measurement phase should increasingly distinguish between outputs and outcomes. Attendance, tests and donations show what was delivered; stronger outcome data will show what changes in knowledge, behaviour, referral completion, repeat donation, access and decision-making.

08 | EDUCATION & AWARENESS

Knowledge before the decision

Young people make important decisions about relationships, family, health and identity long before many will routinely engage with specialist health services. Schools therefore offer a powerful opportunity for early, accurate and non-stigmatising sickle cell education.

One Desire has engaged students across senior high schools including Labone SHS, St. John's Grammar School and Accra Academy, with additional school-based work reflected in the organisation's broader activity record. Sessions are designed to move beyond definitions and create space for direct questions about genotype, inheritance, relationships, testing and the realities of sickle cell disease.

Our education approach emphasises informed choice rather than fear. Students should leave knowing why genotype matters, where screening fits into responsible decision-making, why sickle cell should not be a source of stigma, and what actions they can take for themselves and others.

THE SCALE OPPORTUNITY

- Develop a structured school education module with standardised learning objectives.
- Train youth facilitators and health professionals to deliver consistent sessions.
- Link education days to screening and counselling opportunities where appropriate.
- Introduce simple pre- and post-session knowledge measures.
- Develop teacher and student resources that allow learning to continue after the outreach.
- Create a school engagement database that tracks institutions reached, repeat engagements and follow-up opportunities.

09 | SCREENING & INFORMED CHOICES

Knowing your status can change the conversation

Awareness about genotype becomes more useful when people also have a practical route to testing. One Desire therefore integrates screening opportunities into selected activities and partnerships, helping participants move from curiosity to knowledge.

At One Wash, One Hope, 86 genotype tests were recorded. During the Osu outreach, more than 70 people were tested. These experiences demonstrate the value of bringing screening closer to communities and integrating it into environments where people already feel comfortable participating.

Screening should never be treated as an endpoint. A stronger model connects testing with clear communication, appropriate counselling, confidentiality, referral and an understanding of what the result means for the individual.

NEXT PHASE

- Strengthen pre- and post-test counselling pathways.
- Formalise referral relationships with appropriate health facilities and professionals.
- Improve confidential data capture and follow-up.
- Explore subsidised screening models with laboratories, health partners and funders.
- Track how screening knowledge influences subsequent health or relationship decisions where ethically appropriate and consented.

10 | BLOOD DONATION

Turning awareness into a lifesaving act

A pint of blood can mean the difference between crisis and recovery. For people living with sickle cell disease, access to blood can become an urgent necessity. That understanding has shaped One Desire's commitment to mobilising people not only to learn about sickle cell disease, but also to contribute to the wider blood supply.

The Foundation's updated activity record reports eight blood donation drives within an eleven-month period and more than 400 pints of blood mobilised. At One Wash, One Hope, 49 people donated blood. At the Asesewa Senior High School outreach and blood donation exercise on 11 February 2026, 92 students gave blood.

Our donor mobilisation approach aims to make blood donation visible, understandable and socially meaningful - especially for young people who can become repeat donors over many years.

THE NEXT STEP: REPEAT-DONOR COMMUNITIES

- Build recurring donor partnerships with schools, universities, companies, churches and youth networks.

- Develop donor follow-up and return-donor communication.
- Combine donor drives with clear education about blood needs and eligibility.
- Work closely with recognised blood-service partners on safety, logistics and reporting.
- Track first-time versus returning donors so growth in donor retention can be demonstrated.

11 | COMMUNITY OUTREACH & SUPPORT

Health engagement that meets people where they are

Community outreach allows One Desire to respond to the social realities around health. People may need information and screening, but they may also need practical support, trusted conversation, referrals and a sense that they are not being approached only as statistics.

In Dawa Tokro, Hugs & Smiles - delivered with The Perrie Foundation - demonstrated the value of relational, accessible community engagement. The activity created space for interaction, support and participation rather than a one-directional health lecture.

The Osu outreach with White Jades demonstrated another dimension of this model. More than 70 people were tested, alongside medication support and the distribution of over 1,000 items of clothing and more than 150 books.

Health programmes become more credible when communities experience respect, practical value and continuity.

One Desire's long-term opportunity is to strengthen follow-up so that community outreach becomes an entry point into sustained information, referral and support.

12 | CAMPAIGN INNOVATION

Designing public-health experiences people want to join

One Desire experiments with formats that make health action social, memorable and relevant to younger audiences. Rather than relying only on seminars, the Foundation creates experiences that combine health services with community, culture, conversation and participation.

ONE WASH, ONE HOPE

Held on 20 September 2025 at Untamed Empire, One Wash, One Hope combined a car wash and pop-up market with sickle cell awareness, blood donation and genotype screening. More than 400 people attended, 72 cars were recorded, 49 people donated blood and 86 genotype tests were completed.

YOU FOR KNOW

You For Know is a youth campaign built around the message: Know Yourself, Know Your Choices, Know What To Do. The 2026 activation was designed to combine genotype/sickling screening, blood donation, CPR/basic emergency response training, fireside conversations and immersive sickle cell education.

The One Wash activation demonstrated that health education does not always need to look like a seminar. When public health is integrated into spaces young people enjoy, participation can become easier and more organic.

For the final public version of this profile, the You For Know section should be updated with verified post-event results once attendance, screening, blood donation, CPR participation and other programme records are finalised.

13 | ADVOCACY & POLICY ENGAGEMENT

From community experience to stronger systems

Community action is essential, but sustainable progress also requires stronger systems. One Desire therefore sees advocacy as an extension of programme delivery: the experiences of people, volunteers and communities should help shape conversations about access, screening, blood supply, medicines, specialist care, stigma and financing.

In June 2026, One Desire's leadership participated in the 3rd Annual ISCC Sickle Cell Disease Conference, including moderation and closing engagement. Platforms like this create opportunities to connect grassroots experience with clinicians, advocates, researchers and decision-makers.

OUR ADVOCACY INTERESTS

- Earlier and more accessible screening, including stronger newborn screening systems.
- Improved access to essential sickle cell medicines and appropriate care.
- Stronger blood supply and voluntary donor mobilisation.
- Specialist training, referral pathways and patient-centred services.
- Better data and evidence for planning.
- Greater visibility of sickle cell disease within public-health and development priorities.

As One Desire's evidence base grows, the Foundation aims to translate programme learning into credible briefs, partnerships, public engagement and policy dialogue.

14 | PARTNERSHIPS

Impact is collaborative

One Desire's early work has been strengthened by organisations and individuals that have contributed technical expertise, health services, community access, venues, supplies, communications, volunteer support and other resources.

Our partnership philosophy is straightforward: collaboration should make the experience or outcome better for the people being served.

HEALTH & TECHNICAL PARTNERS

Clinical expertise, screening, counselling, laboratory support, referral and health education.

COMMUNITY PARTNERS

Local trust, participant mobilisation, venues, social support and contextual knowledge.

ADVOCACY & KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS

Research, evidence, conferences, policy engagement, training and public-health learning.

BLOOD MOBILISATION PARTNERS

Safe blood collection, donor mobilisation, logistics and repeat-donor development.

CORPORATE & IN-KIND SUPPORTERS

Funding, transport, media, printing, equipment, refreshments, staff volunteers and other operational support.

WHAT WE VALUE IN PARTNERSHIP

One Desire seeks relationships that are transparent, mutually respectful and aligned with the Foundation's mission. The strongest partnerships contribute not only resources, but also quality, credibility, access, learning and continuity.

15 | OUR PEOPLE

Powered by people who choose to act

One Desire is youth-led, but its work depends on a wider ecosystem of volunteers, health professionals, advisers, partners and community members. The organisation's growing volunteer base has supported mobilisation, event coordination, health activities, communications, logistics, documentation and community engagement.

FOUNDER & EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

David Akande founded One Desire Sickle Cell Foundation in September 2024 and provides strategic leadership across the Foundation's programmes, partnerships, advocacy and organisational development. His work spans youth leadership, public health advocacy, development and international engagement. Through One Desire, he has helped mobilise young people, health professionals, community organisations and institutional partners around sickle cell education, genotype screening, blood donation and community action.

GOVERNANCE & SECRETARIAT

One Desire is developing an institutional structure designed to support accountable growth, including governance oversight, programme coordination, technical input and a functioning secretariat. As formal appointments are confirmed, the Foundation's public profile should distinguish clearly between Board oversight, Secretariat responsibilities and technical/scientific advisory roles.

OUR VOLUNTEER MOVEMENT

More than 50 volunteers have contributed to the organisation's early growth. Volunteers support school engagements, community outreach, blood donor mobilisation, screening activities, participant registration, logistics, communications, documentation and other behind-the-scenes responsibilities.

As programmes expand, One Desire aims to strengthen volunteer recruitment, onboarding, training, safeguarding, team allocation, leadership development, retention and recognition. The ambition is not simply to have more volunteers, but to develop young people who understand sickle cell disease and see themselves as active contributors to better public health.

16 | HOW WE CREATE CHANGE

From reach to influence

One Desire's emerging theory of change is built around five connected stages. The model recognises that awareness alone is insufficient; meaningful change requires a pathway from exposure to understanding, personal knowledge, action and wider influence.

1	2	3	4	5
REACH	**UNDERSTAND**	**KNOW**	**ACT**	**INFLUENCE**
Meet people where they already trust and participate.	Provide clear, relevant and non-stigmatising information.	Create opportunities for screening and counselling.	Enable donation, referrals, choices, volunteering and support.	Use evidence and experience to strengthen systems.

This pathway provides a useful framework for both programme design and measurement. Each activity should be able to identify which stage or stages it is intended to influence and what evidence will demonstrate progress.

17 | WHERE WE ARE GOING

From activations to sustainable programmes

One Desire's first phase has demonstrated that young people and communities will engage when sickle cell education is practical, accessible and connected to action. The next phase is about building the systems that allow this engagement to become sustained impact.

SCALE SCHOOL-BASED EDUCATION

Develop a repeatable programme capable of reaching more schools with consistent content, measurement and screening/referral pathways.

BUILD REPEAT-DONOR COMMUNITIES

Move from one-off blood drives toward networks of informed, returning voluntary donors.

MEASURE OUTCOMES

Invest in monitoring and evaluation so One Desire can demonstrate not only reach, but changes in knowledge, behaviour, referrals and participation.

DEEPEN ADVOCACY

Translate programme evidence and community realities into stronger public conversations and policy engagement.

EXPAND SCREENING ACCESS

Build partnerships that reduce cost and bring genotype/sickling screening and counselling closer to young people and communities.

STRENGTHEN SUPPORT PATHWAYS

Improve referral, community support and practical connections for people and families affected by sickle cell disease.

INSTITUTIONALISE ONE DESIRE

Strengthen governance, staffing, safeguarding, financial systems, communications, volunteer management and sustainable fundraising.

18 | PARTNERSHIP PROPOSITION

What your partnership can unlock

One Desire has demonstrated the ability to mobilise people. Strategic partnership can help transform that mobilisation into stronger, repeatable and measurable programmes.

YOUR SUPPORT COULD HELP US

- Take structured sickle cell education into more schools and communities.
- Subsidise genotype and sickling screening for young people.
- Strengthen counselling, referral and follow-up pathways.
- Mobilise and retain voluntary blood donors.
- Equip and train volunteers and programme teams.
- Develop stronger monitoring, evaluation and data systems.
- Expand community outreach and patient-centred support.
- Produce evidence and communications that strengthen advocacy.
- Build the institutional systems required for sustainable growth.

WAYS TO PARTNER

Strategic Funding Partner	Support an annual programme, geographic expansion or a defined portfolio of activities.
Screening Partner	Provide test kits, laboratory services, counselling capacity or subsidised testing.
Blood Mobilisation Partner	Co-host donor drives and support repeat-donor engagement.
Health & Technical Partner	Contribute clinical expertise, training, referrals, research or quality assurance.
Corporate / In-Kind Partner	Provide transport, venues, media, printing, equipment, technology, staff volunteers or other resources.
Evidence & Advocacy Partner	Strengthen monitoring, research, policy translation, convening and dissemination.

"Event funding creates moments. Institutional funding creates continuity."

19 | MONITORING, LEARNING & ACCOUNTABILITY

Measuring more than attendance

One Desire's early records provide important evidence of reach and mobilisation. As the organisation grows, a stronger monitoring, evaluation and learning system will help demonstrate what changes because of the work and improve programme quality.

REACH	ACTION	OUTCOME
How many people encountered or participated in an activity?	How many people screened, donated, completed training, received support, volunteered or followed a referral?	What changed in knowledge, behaviour, repeat participation, access, decision-making or support after engagement?

PROPOSED INDICATORS

- People reached by programme and demographic group.
- Number of screenings completed and counselling/referrals provided.
- Blood donors mobilised, including first-time and repeat donors.
- Knowledge change before and after educational activities.
- Referral completion where follow-up is appropriate and consented.
- Volunteer recruitment, training and retention.
- Partner contributions and programme leverage.
- Participant satisfaction and qualitative stories of change.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Accountability also requires responsible financial management, safeguarding, data protection, transparent partner reporting and honest communication about both achievements and limitations. As institutional funding grows, these systems should grow with it.

20 | JOIN THE MOVEMENT

Help us make sickle cell knowledge practical, support visible and action normal

One Desire began with a desire to change how people understand and respond to sickle cell disease. In its first two years, that desire has mobilised thousands of people, school communities, blood donors, volunteers, health professionals and partners.

The opportunity ahead is to build on that momentum: reaching more young people before critical decisions are made, making screening easier to access, strengthening voluntary blood donation, supporting communities with dignity, measuring what changes and carrying credible evidence into wider advocacy.

"The question is not whether people will engage. They already have. The question is how far this movement can go with the right partners beside it."

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Raising Awareness, Inspiring Hope & Advocating for Change.

Publication note: programme figures should be checked against final activity records before external distribution. You For Know 2026 results should be updated once verified post-event data is available.